LESSON PLAN · FINANCIAL LITERACY (GR 3–5) BEGINNER: MONEY SMART · LEVEL 1

Lesson 7: Digital Money and Staying Safe

Module 2 | 45 minutes | Digital money safety | Grades 3–6 · ages 8–11

Objective: Explain simply how UPI, QR codes and cards move money, and follow the safety rules: never share a PIN or OTP, always ask a grown-up, and spot scams.

Success criteria

- I can explain what UPI, QR codes and cards do.
- I can say why a PIN and an OTP must stay secret.
- I can spot red flags in a scam message.
- I always ask a grown-up before any online payment.

Key vocabulary

- **UPI**: A way to send money between bank accounts using a phone.
- **QR code**: A square of dots that tells the app which shop to pay.
- **PIN**: A secret number that only the account owner knows.
- **OTP**: A one-time password sent by text message to confirm a payment.
- **scam**: A trick to steal money or secrets.
- **red flag**: A warning sign that something is wrong.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash (lesson video, activities)
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone); a microphone helps for speaking tasks
- Printed worksheet, paper and pencil
- Project files: l07_money_safety_sheet.md, l07_teacher_script.md

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	“Secret keeper” role-play: the owner always says “No. I will tell a grown-up.”
4 min	**Watch + poll**	Play the video. Poll: “Have you seen a grown-up pay by scanning a QR code?” (thumbs).
6 min	**Live demo**	Pretend QR payment steps, the fake prize message, and acting out the “bank” call with a volunteer.
6 min	**Build along**	Be a scam detective: three phone screens, circle red flags, safe or scam, the right action.
5 min	**Team competition**	“Safe or unsafe?” sort in two teams; each team explains one card.

5 min	**Budget sim**	Online stationery order (with a grown-up). Ask: who spotted the scam item?
4 min	**Pairs**	Breakout pairs: digital money words match and the safe UPI steps order.
4 min	**Probe**	New situation: the “bank” call. Pairs role-play the right answer.
6 min	**Poster + show-and-tell**	Start the money safety rules poster; three learners show their rules. Exit ticket.

Unplugged warm-up

Secret keeper (5 min): one child is the “account owner” with a secret 4-digit number on a folded paper. Other children play tricksters and try to get the number with lines from cards (“I’m from the bank!”, “You won a prize!”, “Hurry, your account will close!”). The owner must say “No. I will tell a grown-up.” every time. Swap roles twice. Then ask: “Which trick felt the most convincing?”

Teaching the idea

Digital money is real money moved between bank accounts, by UPI on a phone or with a card. Explain just enough: a QR code tells the app which shop to pay; the name and amount are checked before the PIN; a PIN is only needed to send money, never to receive it. The heart of the lesson is safety: never share a PIN, OTP or password, always ask a grown-up, and treat free prizes, rushes and “bank” calls asking for secrets as red flags. Children at this age must never make payments themselves; they help their families stay safe by spotting scams.

Analogy: A PIN or OTP is like the key to your home: you would never hand it to a stranger at the door, even if they say they are from the building office.

Live demo: Use slides or a printed picture, never a real payment or a real phone screen with account details. 1) Show a pretend QR code on a shop counter picture. 2) Walk through the six UPI steps from the video, pointing at “check the name” and “check the amount” before the PIN. 3) Show the fake prize message and ask the class to call out red flags. 4) Act out the “bank” call: you are the caller, a volunteer refuses and says “I will tell a grown-up.” Applaud. 5) Open the online stationery sim and show that the “prize” item breaks the savings goal, and is a scam anyway.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What does UPI do?	Moves money from one bank account to another using a phone.
What do you check after scanning a QR code?	The shop’s name and the amount.
Who can you share an OTP with?	No one. Not even someone who says they are from the bank.

Do you need a PIN to receive money?	No. A PIN is only for sending money.
Name two red flags in a message.	Any two of: a prize you never entered, paying to get something free, a rush, asking for a PIN or OTP, a strange link.

Differentiation

Support
Focus on two rules only: never share a PIN or OTP, and always ask a grown-up. Use picture cards for the safe or unsafe sort.

Stretch
Write your own pretend scam message with three red flags, swap with a partner, and see if they can find all three.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Digital money is not real money.	It is real money in a bank account. When it is sent, it is gone.
If someone says they are from the bank, it is okay to share the OTP.	Real banks never ask for a PIN or OTP. It is always a scam.
You need to enter a PIN to receive money.	Never. A PIN is only needed to send money.
Free prizes online are lucky wins.	If you never entered and they want money first, it is a scam.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
A message says: “You won ₹5,000! Share your OTP to get it.” Write two red flags and what you will do.

Homework
Finish your money safety rules poster and stick it up at home. Teach one rule to a grown-up or an older sibling.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Safe or unsafe? (perform · categorize)

Safe: Asking a grown-up before any online payment, Checking the shop's name after scanning a QR code, Keeping a PIN secret, Telling a grown-up about a strange message
Unsafe: Telling a caller the OTP from Papa's phone, Clicking a "free prize" link, Scanning a QR code a stranger sent to "receive" money, Writing the PIN on the back of the card

2. Digital money words (perform · matching)

UPI → Sending money between bank accounts using a phone · QR code → A square of dots you scan to pay a shop · PIN → A secret number only the account owner knows · OTP → A one-time password sent by text message · Debit card → A card that takes money straight from the bank account · Scam → A trick to steal money or secrets

3. Paying safely with UPI (perform · ordering)

Order: Ask a grown-up to pay with their phone → Scan the shop's QR code → Check the shop's name on the screen → Check the amount is right → The grown-up types the secret PIN, hiding the screen → Wait for the "payment successful" screen and show the shopkeeper

4. Online stationery order (with a grown-up) (perform · budget sim)

Must buy: 📐 Geometry box, 🖍️ Colour pencils, 🚚 Delivery charge · **Keep at least** ₹100. The three needs cost ₹240, leaving ₹160. Keeping ₹100 means only ₹60 more: the sticky notes or the glitter pens fit, but not both. The "free phone prize" is a scam: you should never pay to get a prize. Do not click, and tell a grown-up.

5. New situation: the "bank" call (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Not share it, end the call and tell a grown-up straight away

6. Project: my money safety rules poster (probe · project)

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** UPI = A way to send money between bank accounts using a phone. · QR code = A square of dots that tells the app which shop to pay. · PIN = A secret number that only the account owner knows. · OTP = A one-time password sent by text message to confirm a payment.
2. **Safe or unsafe?:** Safe: Asking a grown-up before any online payment, Checking the shop's name after scanning a QR code, Keeping a PIN secret, Telling a grown-up about a strange

message · Unsafe: Telling a caller the OTP from Papa's phone, Clicking a "free prize" link, Scanning a QR code a stranger sent to "receive" money, Writing the PIN on the back of the card

3. **Digital money words:** UPI → Sending money between bank accounts using a phone · QR code → A square of dots you scan to pay a shop · PIN → A secret number only the account owner knows · OTP → A one-time password sent by text message · Debit card → A card that takes money straight from the bank account · Scam → A trick to steal money or secrets
4. **Paying safely with UPI:** 1 Ask a grown-up to pay with their phone · 2 Scan the shop's QR code · 3 Check the shop's name on the screen · 4 Check the amount is right · 5 The grown-up types the secret PIN, hiding the screen · 6 Wait for the "payment successful" screen and show the shopkeeper
5. **Online stationery order (with a grown-up):** Must buy: 📐 Geometry box, 🖍️ Colour pencils, 🚚 Delivery charge. Keep at least ₹100. The three needs cost ₹240, leaving ₹160. Keeping ₹100 means only ₹60 more: the sticky notes or the glitter pens fit, but not both. The "free phone prize" is a scam: you should never pay to get a prize. Do not click, and tell a grown-up.

Kitabash original curriculum.